

4.3 What To Look For

As we've already mentioned, none of the software reviewed here are bad, and all of them will get the job done. Here's a few basic things you should look out for when deciding on a video editing software:

OS: Is your operating system supported? As we've mentioned, if you're running an older version of Windows, make sure that the software you're downloading / buying supports it. There can be nothing more irritating than finding out that the Rs 5,000 you just spent is a complete waste, unless you spend another five to 10 thousand on upgrading your OS!

Try before you buy: Waste some bandwidth and download the trial versions of the software. See if it's what you want, and whether you can use it before you spend money on it.

Ease Of Use: Depending on your level of experience, choose a software that you will not struggle to use. The best way to find out is to use the trial version, and decide whether the ease of use of the software matches your skills. This can work both ways: a novice might find it too hard to use a professional software, and a professional may soon grow tired of a software that has an overly simple layout.

Features: Look for features that you will need when editing your home movies. It's a good idea to make a storyboard, and then imagine the effects that you would like to use in your head. Then look at the software specifications to confirm whether your dream movie can be made or not.

Help / Support: Before you go out and buy the software, read up on some forums and do a little bit of searching to find out how easy it is to get help with the software. We're not just talking customer support here, but also in terms of online communities. The easier it is to find a problem you're facing just by using a search